

# AI Entrepreneurship & Innovation

## Weekend Incubator Track — From AI Capability to a Validated Startup

|                                  |                                    |                                 |                          |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Duration: 3 Months (12 Weekends) | Schedule: Saturdays & Sundays only | Format: Hands-on Incubator Labs | Fee: ■599 (All Students) |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------|

### Program Overview

This is a structured incubator track that teaches students how to convert AI technical capability into a validated commercial product and startup. Classes run **only on Saturdays and Sundays across 3 months**, so working students and full-time learners can join without disrupting their weekday academic or professional schedules.

The track follows a single build-as-you-learn pipeline: **Problem Statement** → **Functional MVP** → **Business Model** → **Final Pitch**. Every weekend adds a concrete artifact to this pipeline, so by demo day each student defends a working prototype, a validated business model, and an investor-ready pitch — not just lecture notes.

**Core Skills Covered:** MVP Prototyping • Business Model Canvas • Investor Pitch Decks • Unit Economics & GTM Strategy

### Program Structure & Modular Progression

| Module                          | Schedule      | Core Focus & Deliverable                                                            |
|---------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 — Problem & Market Discovery | Weekends 1–4  | Find and validate a real customer problem worth solving (Problem Statement Lock-In) |
| 02 — AI Opportunity & Rapid MVP | Weekends 5–8  | Identify high-value 10x AI use cases and build a working functional prototype       |
| 03 — Business Model & Pitching  | Weekends 9–11 | Turn the MVP into a scalable business model, unit economics, and fundable pitch     |
| Capstone Defense — Final Pitch  | Weekend 12    | Present and defend the full venture before an investor-style evaluation panel       |

*\* Note: Classes are held strictly on Saturdays and Sundays for the full 3-month duration — no weekday commitments.*

### Weekend-by-Weekend Syllabus (Weekends 1 to 12)

| Week end | Module & Title                                                        | Schedule & Topics (Saturday / Sunday)                                                                                                                                                                                    | Milestone Deliverable                           |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| W1       | Weekend 1: Design Thinking & Pain Points<br><a href="#">Mod 1</a>     | Saturday: Introduction to design thinking; empathy mapping; identifying real user pain points.<br>Sunday: Hands-on: map 3 candidate pain points from your own experience or target community; peer critique.             | MILESTONE: Problem Statement initiation         |
| W2       | Weekend 2: Customer Discovery Interviews<br><a href="#">Mod 1</a>     | Saturday: Interview design: writing unbiased questions, avoiding leading the witness, structuring a discovery call.<br>Sunday: Conduct 3–5 mock customer discovery interviews; synthesize findings into a problem brief. | Problem brief synthesis from customer discovery |
| W3       | Weekend 3: Competitor Matrix & Market Sizing<br><a href="#">Mod 1</a> | Saturday: Competitive analysis frameworks; direct vs indirect competitors; positioning maps.<br>Sunday: Workshop: build a competitor matrix and a TAM/SAM/SOM market-sizing estimate for your idea.                      | Competitor matrix & TAM/SAM/SOM market model    |
| W4       | Weekend 4: Problem Statement Lock-In<br><a href="#">Mod 1</a>         | Saturday: Peer review of problem briefs, market sizing, and competitor matrices; instructor feedback.<br>Sunday: Finalize and present a validated Problem Statement to the cohort.                                       | MILESTONE: Validated Problem Statement locked   |
| W5       | Weekend 5: Where AI Creates 10x Value<br><a href="#">Mod 2</a>        | Saturday: Framework for spotting AI opportunities vs plain automation; case studies of 10x value creation.<br>Sunday: Opportunity-mapping exercise: apply the framework to your own validated problem.                   | AI Opportunity-mapping & 10x value matrix       |

|            |                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                            |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>W6</b>  | <b>Weekend 6: Rapid Prototyping Toolkit</b><br><a href="#">Mod 2</a>               | Saturday: Tour of low-code and AI-assisted build tools for fast prototyping.<br>Sunday: Build the first clickable/functional version of your prototype.                                           | <i>MILESTONE: Functional MVP first clickable build</i>     |
| <b>W7</b>  | <b>Weekend 7: MVP Build Sprint</b><br><a href="#">Mod 2</a>                        | Saturday: Iterate on the prototype; add the core AI-driven feature.<br>Sunday: Continue the build sprint; instructor office hours for debugging and scoping.                                      | <i>Functional MVP build sprint &amp; AI integration</i>    |
| <b>W8</b>  | <b>Weekend 8: Validating the MVP</b><br><a href="#">Mod 2</a>                      | Saturday: Methods for testing an MVP with early users; structuring a feedback session.<br>Sunday: Run live validation sessions with early users; collect and log feedback on your Functional MVP. | <i>MILESTONE: Functional MVP validated with users</i>      |
| <b>W9</b>  | <b>Weekend 9: Business Model Canvas</b><br><a href="#">Mod 3</a>                   | Saturday: Business Model Canvas (BMC) fundamentals; revenue model options for AI products.<br>Sunday: Build a complete BMC and revenue model for your validated MVP.                              | <i>Complete Business Model Canvas &amp; unit economics</i> |
| <b>W10</b> | <b>Weekend 10: Go-To-Market Strategy</b><br><a href="#">Mod 3</a>                  | Saturday: GTM frameworks: channels, positioning, early-adopter acquisition.<br>Sunday: Build a GTM plan; finalize the Business Model.                                                             | <i>MILESTONE: Business Model &amp; GTM plan locked</i>     |
| <b>W11</b> | <b>Weekend 11: Investor Pitch Deck</b><br><a href="#">Mod 3</a>                    | Saturday: Pitch deck structure and storytelling for investors; anatomy of a 10-slide deck.<br>Sunday: Build a draft pitch deck; peer review and iterate.                                          | <i>10-slide investor pitch deck draft &amp; iteration</i>  |
| <b>W12</b> | <b>Weekend 12: Startup Validation &amp; Pitch Deck</b><br><a href="#">Capstone</a> | Saturday: Pitch rehearsal; feedback session with instructors and mentors.<br>Sunday: Final Pitch — capstone defense in front of an investor-style panel.                                          | <i>MILESTONE: Final Pitch defended before panel</i>        |

## Capstone Defense — Startup Validation & Pitch Deck

Every student's work runs through one execution pipeline across the 12 weekends: **1. Problem Statement** → **2. Functional MVP** → **3. Business Model** → **4. Final Pitch**.

### Employer- & Investor-Ready Deliverables Produced:

- **Working MVP Prototype:** Functional, user-testable software product powered by an AI core feature.
- **Validated Business Model Canvas:** Tested unit economics, pricing strategy, customer segments, and revenue streams.
- **Go-To-Market (GTM) Playbook:** Actionable channel distribution and customer acquisition strategy.
- **10-Slide Investor Pitch Deck:** High-impact executive deck synthesized for pre-seed/angel investors.
- **Panel Defense:** On the final Sunday, each student defends their venture live before an investor-style panel.

## Graduate Learning Outcomes

By the conclusion of this incubator track, students will be verified capable to:

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>✓ Apply design thinking to identify and validate customer pain points</li> <li>✓ Run structured customer discovery interviews and synthesize findings</li> <li>✓ Build a competitor matrix and size a market (TAM/SAM/SOM)</li> <li>✓ Distinguish where AI creates outsized value vs simple automation</li> <li>✓ Rapidly prototype a functional MVP using low-code &amp; AI tools</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>✓ Validate an MVP with early users and iterate on real feedback</li> <li>✓ Build a Business Model Canvas and defensible revenue model</li> <li>✓ Design a go-to-market strategy for an early-stage AI product</li> <li>✓ Craft and deliver a high-impact, investor-ready pitch deck</li> <li>✓ Defend a complete venture — problem, product, model, pitch — to a panel</li> </ul> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|